

RailCore Growth Pathway Program

Leader Track Worksheet Packet

Stronger Teams. Safer Tracks. Better Journeys.

Use this packet during the 3-hour Leader Track workshop. Each worksheet supports one inquiry-based activity and helps turn discussion into practical leadership actions for IDP adoption.

Participant Name	
Team / Department	
Session Date	

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Worksheet 1: Talent Challenge Map

Section 2 | Talent Challenges Before IDPs

Purpose: Identify the talent-management challenges that make structured development planning necessary. Work in small groups and complete the map below.

Talent challenge most visible in our area	
What happens if we do not address it?	
Who is affected? Employees, managers, teams, customers, operations, business results	
Evidence or examples we are seeing	
Why this matters now	

Group share: Be ready to share one priority challenge, its impact, and why it matters now.

Worksheet 2: Challenge-to-IDP Connection

Section 3 | IDPs as a Strategic Talent Tool

Purpose: Connect a real talent challenge to the practical value of an Individual Development Plan. Focus on visibility, consistency, accountability, retention, capability building, or succession readiness.

The challenge is...	
Why it matters...	
How IDPs could help make this issue more visible	
How IDPs could make action more consistent or accountable	
What leadership support is required	
One practical example of IDP use in this situation	

Worksheet 3: IDP Journey Risk Map

Section 4 | The IDP Journey: What Leaders Need to Know

Purpose: Identify where the IDP process may break down and define what leaders can reinforce at each step.

IDP Step	What could go wrong?	Why might it happen?	Leader action to reduce risk
1. Reflect			
2. Discuss			
3. Plan			
4. Document			
5. Follow Up			

Prompt: Which step needs the most leadership attention in your area? Why?

Worksheet 4: Adoption Case Comparison

Section 5 | Effective IDP Adoption

Purpose: Analyze IDP adoption beyond completion rate. Use the two department examples to determine what healthy adoption looks like.

	Department A	Department B
Completion	96%	84%
Goal Quality	Most goals are generic	Goals are specific and role-connected
Follow-Up	Low follow-up rate	Quarterly follow-ups scheduled
Employee Perception	IDPs are seen as paperwork	Employees report clearer development direction

Which department shows healthier adoption? Why?	
What would you ask the leader of Department A?	
What would you ask the leader of Department B?	
What support would you provide?	

Worksheet 5: Barrier-Response Planner

Section 6 | Barriers, Resistance, and Change Adoption

Purpose: Prepare practical leadership responses to common resistance. Choose one barrier and define the message, support action, and follow-up measure.

Possible barriers:

- ☐ This is just another HR task.
- ☐ Managers do not have time.
- ☐ Employees do not know what goals to choose.
- ☐ The system is confusing.
- ☐ No one follows up.
- ☐ Development opportunities are limited.

Selected barrier	
Leader message: What should leaders say?	
Support action: What would make this easier?	
Follow-up measure: How will we know this is improving?	
Owner / next step	

Worksheet 6: Leadership Message Builder

Section 7 | Leader Communication and Buy-In

Purpose: Draft a leadership response that builds buy-in and positions IDPs as useful, not administrative.

Scenario: A department manager says, “My team is already overloaded. IDPs feel like another administrative requirement.”

Acknowledge the concern	
Reframe IDPs as a useful development tool	
Clarify expectations	
Offer support and follow-up	
Final polished message	

Peer feedback: Does the message acknowledge the concern, reframe the purpose, clarify expectations, offer support, and build trust?

Worksheet 7: Dashboard Review

Section 8 | IDP Data, Dashboard, and Accountability

Purpose: Use IDP adoption data to identify risks, ask better leadership questions, and decide support actions.

Team	Completion	Quality	Follow-Up	Possible Risk
Operations	92%	Medium	45%	Follow-up weak
Maintenance	70%	High	80%	Participation gap
Customer Service	98%	Low	30%	Compliance behavior
Safety & Compliance	85%	High	75%	Healthy adoption

Which team needs support first? Why?	
What question would you ask the department manager?	
What leadership action would you take?	
What follow-up rhythm should be used?	
What additional data would you want?	

Worksheet 8: IDP Leadership Playbook Template

Section 9 | Build the IDP Leadership Playbook

Purpose: Draft practical playbook content that leaders can use after the workshop to reinforce IDP adoption.

Playbook Section	Guiding Question	Draft Notes
Leadership Message	What should leaders say about IDPs?	
Manager Expectations	What must managers do consistently?	
Employee Expectations	What must employees own?	
Common Barriers and Responses	What resistance should we prepare for?	
Follow-Up Rhythm	How often should progress be reviewed?	
Success Measures	What data or evidence will show progress?	
Support Resources	What tools, templates, or examples are needed?	

Group output: Share your assigned section, key recommendation, and one practical follow-up action.

Worksheet 9: Leadership Commitment Card

Section 10 | Leadership Commitment & Close

Purpose: Translate the workshop into a personal leadership commitment. Write specific, realistic actions you will take after the session.

One message I will communicate	
One adoption barrier I will address	
One question I will ask managers	
One follow-up rhythm I will use	
One support action I will provide	
My first next step and target date	

IDPs become meaningful when leaders make development visible, expected, supported, and followed up.